and decisions debated. Scientists, it must be remembered, are basical y emotional people. Once they stumble, it is difficult for them to pul themselves together. Setbacks and disappointments have always been and always wil be an inherent part of any career, even one in science. However, I did not want any of my scientists to face disappointments alone. I also wanted to ensure that none of them set their goals when they were at a low ebb. To avoid such eventualities a Science Council was created—a sort of panchayat where the community would sit together and take common decisions. Every three months, al scientists —juniors and seniors, veterans and freshers— would sit together and let off steam.

The very first meeting of the Council was eventful. After a spel of half-hearted enquiries and expressions of doubt, one senior scientist, MN Rao, shot a straight question: “On what basis did you select these five Pandavas (he meant the Project Directors)?” I was, in fact, expecting this question. I wanted to tel him that I found al these five Pandavas married to the Draupadi of positive thinking. Instead, I told Rao to wait and see. I had chosen them to take charge of a long-term programme where new storms